Event-Triggered API for Wealth Advisors (ET-WAPI)

Empowering wealth advisors with real-time life-event intelligence to strengthen client relationships and drive growth.

Product Type: Internal platform product (B2B infrastructure API) designed to power advisor workflows by delivering timely, enriched life-event data. This is not a consumer-facing tool but a backend intelligence layer that integrates with CRM and advisor platforms.

Team: [Awesome]
Contributors: [PM]
Resources: [Designs], [Analytics], [Notes]
Status: **Draft**
Last Updated: Friday, April 25, 2025

Problem Alignment

Describe the problem we are trying to solve: Today, financial advisors lack timely, actionable insights into key client life events such as job changes, marriage, divorce, and inheritance. This gap leads to missed opportunities for proactive engagement, risk management, and personalized financial strategies.

Why does this matter to our customers and business? Advisor engagement is a primary driver of AUM growth, client satisfaction, and firm loyalty. Timely, relevant outreach based on real - life changes strengthens relationships, accelerates product adoption, and increases share of wallet. Without this visibility, firms risk client attrition, diminished wallet share, and competitive disadvantage in an increasingly personalized market.

What evidence or insights do you have to support this?

- Industry studies show that **68% of wealth management clients expect their advisors to anticipate major life events**, without being prompted. (Source: Accenture Wealth Management Consumer Report)

- According to J.D. Power, **timely, personalized communication is the top driver of satisfaction among HNW clients**.

- Quote from a senior advisor: *"I usually find out about a client's divorce or job change through LinkedIn months after the fact — by then, it's a lost opportunity."*

- Quote from a sales director: *"If I had visibility into client promotions in real time, we'd be first to offer portfolio rebalancing or new services — instead of playing catch-up.*

High-Level Approach

We will design a secure, real-time API platform that detects, enriches, and streams confirmed life events directly into wealth management CRM and advisory tools. By leveraging third-party integrations, user - consented data, and enrichment layers, ET - WAPI will empower advisors with immediate, high-confidence insights to take prioritized action.

Narrative

Imagine Priya, a wealth advisor managing 150 clients. Today, she discovers a client went through a divorce six months ago—information that would have warranted a portfolio review, estate planning, and possibly insurance changes. With ET - WAPI, Priya would've been notified the week the divorce was filed and could've proactively scheduled a check-in.

Or take Sameer, a newly promoted VP at a fintech startup. The raise makes him a strong candidate for stock diversification advice. ET - WAPI detects the job title change and

notifies Samir's advisor, who follows up with a tailored portfolio strategy within days, not months.

These stories illustrate how ET - WAPI transforms advisor workflows from reactive to strategic and ensures that wealth firms stay competitive in an increasingly personalized world.

Goals

1. *Enable wealth advisors to proactively engage clients within 7 days of a major life event.*
2. *Achieve a 30% increase in AUM growth opportunities tied to life-event-driven engagements.*
3. *Reach 90% API uptime and webhook delivery reliability.*
4. *Make advisors feel more empowered and confident in their outreach timing and personalization.*
5. *Create a seamless developer experience with self-serve onboarding for CRM/WealthTech teams.*

Non-goals

1. **Predictive Life Event Modeling:**
    - ET - WAPI will not focus on predicting future life events (e.g., "likely to marry") but rather on detecting confirmed events. Predictive models introduce complexity and regulatory risks.
2. **End - User (Client) Notifications:**
    - We will not notify the wealth clients directly about detected life events. Our API serves the advisor experience only.
3. **Comprehensive CRM Platform:**
    - We will not build a full CRM system. ET - WAPI is designed to integrate with existing CRMs, not replace them.

REVIEWER	TEAM/ROLE	STATUS
Varun Nair	Senior Product Manager	Reviewed

Solution Alignment

Primary KPIs:

- Increase in advisor - initiated client engagements within 7 days of a detected event
- % of AUM growth attributed to life-event-triggered actions
- Advisor satisfaction score with API insights (e.g., NPS or internal survey)

Secondary KPIs:

- API adoption rate across CRM platforms and advisor tools
- Webhook delivery success rate
- Precision and recall of life event detection

Hypotheses:

- Before ET - WAPI, <15% of advisor outreach was triggered >one week of a major client life event. We expect this to increase to 50 %+ within 6 months of rollout.
- Advisors who receive prioritized life event feeds will see a 30% higher client engagement rate versus control groups.
- The introduction of real-time triggers will reduce average response time from 21 days to under 5 days.

Note: Baseline metrics will be validated during the Pilot and Beta phases.

Design/Prototype

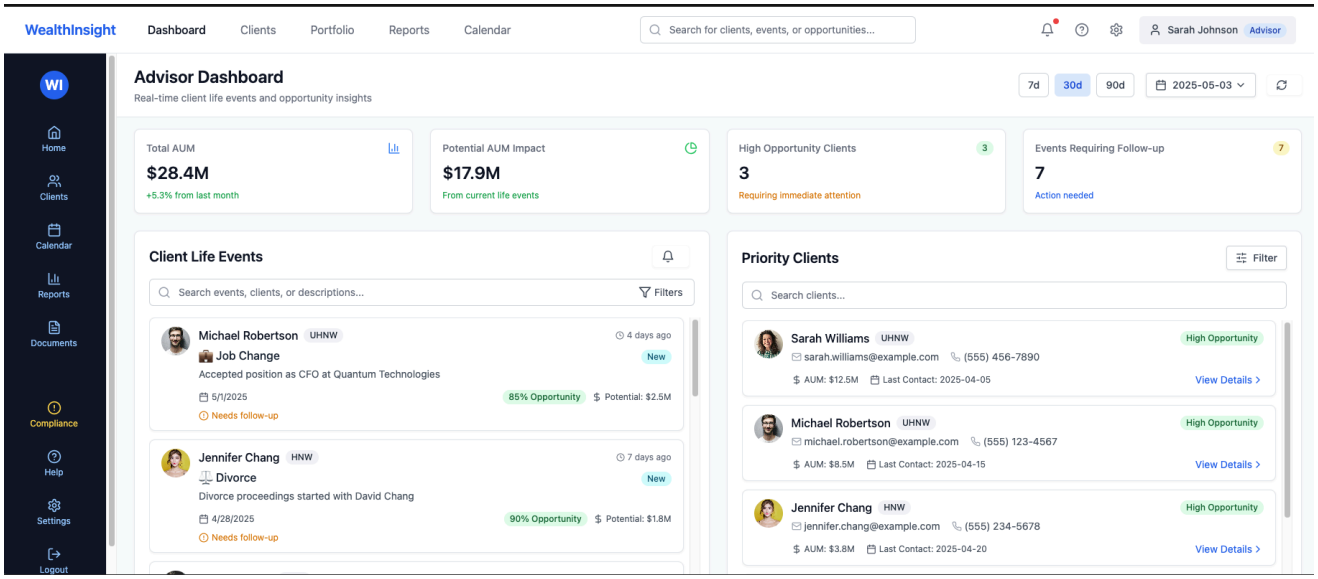
Prompt used

Design a clean, advisor - facing dashboard that visualizes real-time client life events. The interface should include:

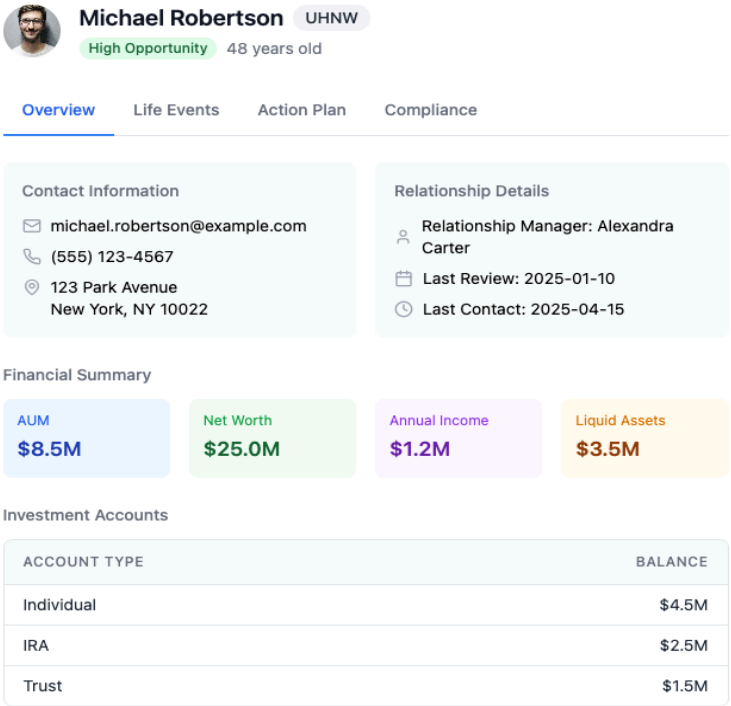
- Event Feed Panel – A scrollable feed showing recent client life events (job change, divorce, retirement, etc.) with timestamps and icons.
- Client Priority View – A prioritized list or card grid of clients based on event urgency and potential AUM impact (e.g., “High Opportunity” label).
- Client Snapshot Modal – When clicking a client, show enriched details like demographics, financial summary, event history, and recommended actions.
- Filters & Tags – Filter by event type, relationship tier (HNW/UHNW), or time window (last 7/30 days).
- Compliance Log Access – A small sidebar or dropdown to view consent status and data source trail.

- Use a modern, professional fintech aesthetic with clean fonts, light backgrounds, and high information density, optimized for desktop use by wealth advisors.

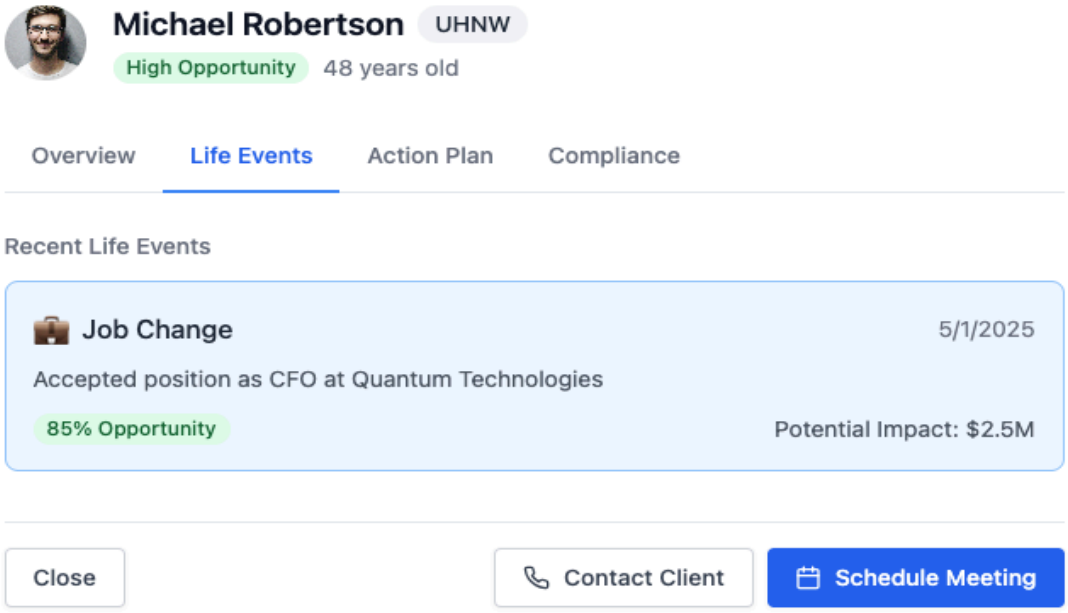
1. Advisor Dashboard



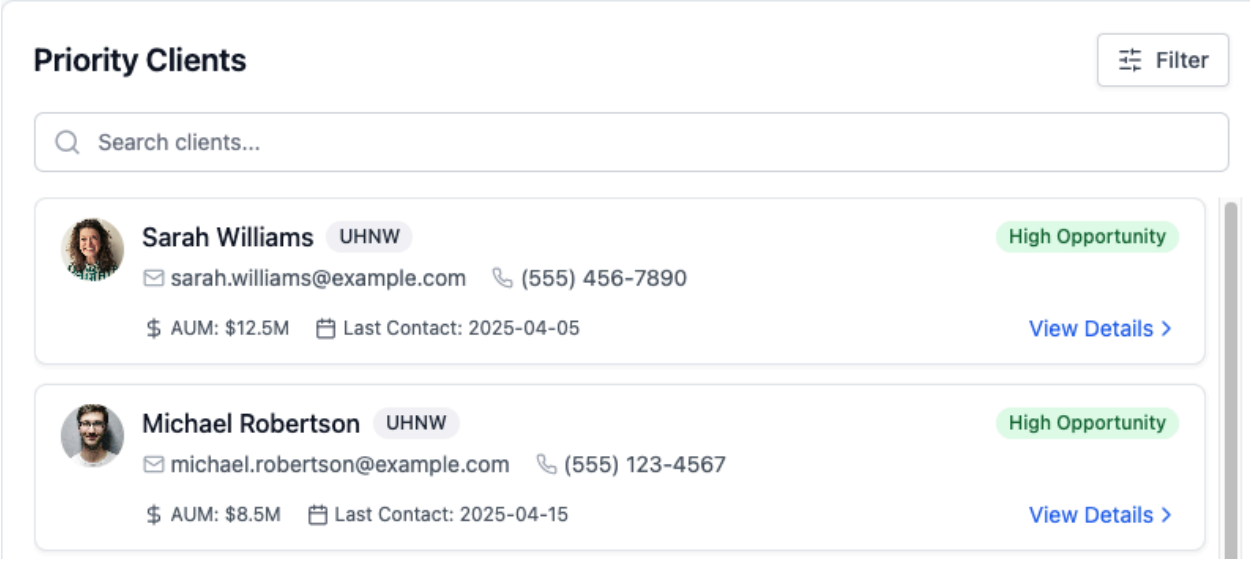
2. Clickable profile of the client who had a recent life event (<5 days ago)



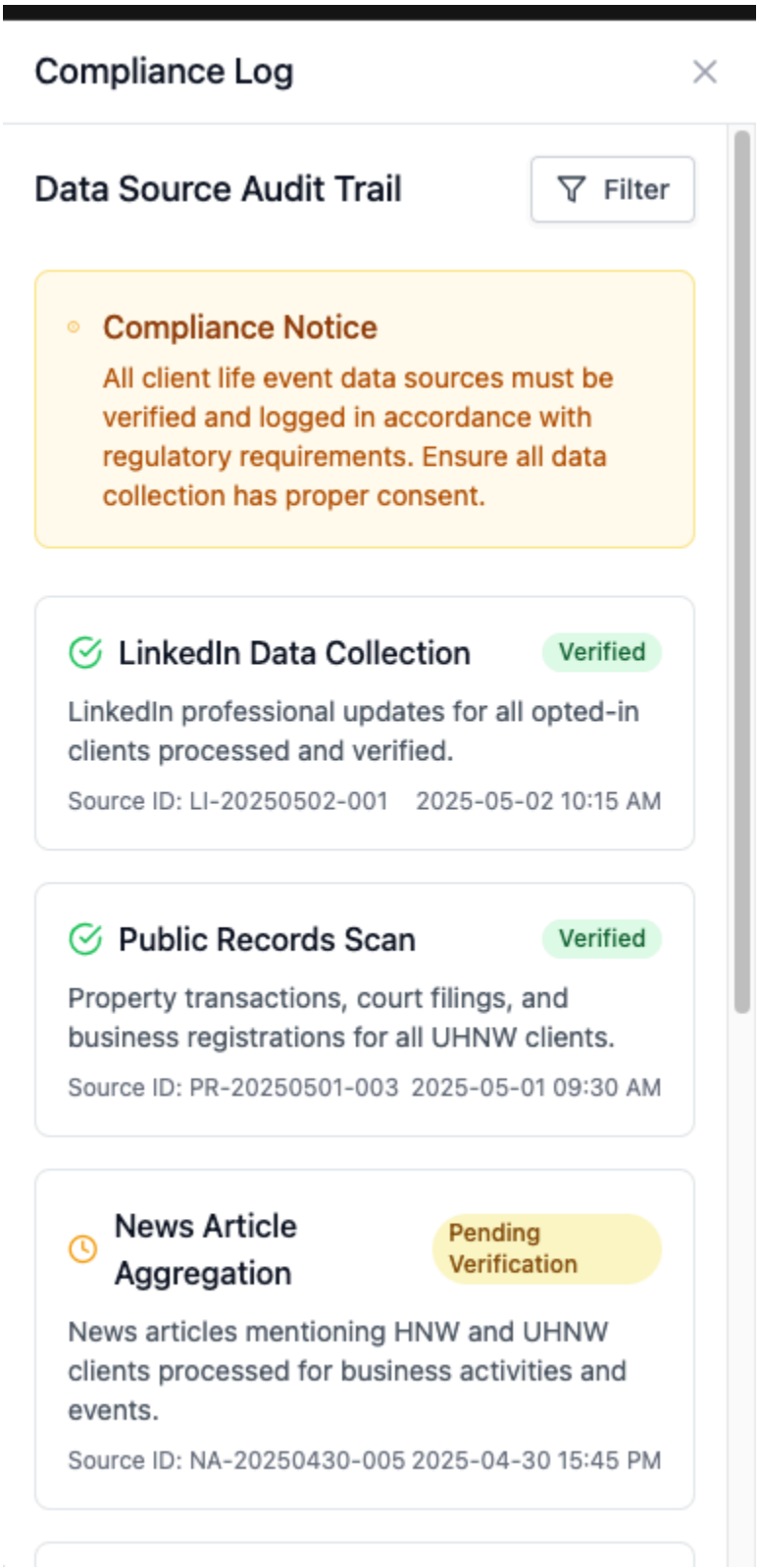
3. Life event details



4. Priority Clients for the advisor are ranked



5. Compliance Log



Key Features

Plan of record

1. ***Life Event Detection API:***
    a. *Real-time identification of confirmed life events (job change, marriage, divorce, retirement, inheritance).*
2. ***Event Streaming via Webhooks:***
    a. *Instant push of life - event signals to subscribing advisor platforms.*
3. ***Event Enrichment Engine:***
    a. *Layer demographic and financial metadata onto raw events to improve actionability.*
4. ***Prioritization Feed:***
    a. *Surface events ranked by urgency and opportunity potential to optimize advisor workflows.*
5. ***Compliance and Consent Layer:***
    a. *Ensure all data is consented, auditable, and compliant with wealth management standards.*

Key Feature Map:

```
[ Life Event Detection API ]
             |
             v
[ Event Enrichment Engine ]
             |
             v
[ Event Streaming via Webhooks ] -------> [ Prioritization Feed for Advisors ]
             |
             v
[ Compliance & Consent Monitoring ]
```

Note: Detailed technical specifications and scaling considerations can be developed in sub-documents for each feature module.

Future considerations

1. ***Predictive Life Event Modeling:***

    a. *Potential future enhancement for probabilistic detection once compliance frameworks mature.*
2. ***Advisor Recommendation Engine:***
    a. *AI - driven suggestion of next best actions tied to specific life events.*
3. ***Cross-Platform Client Timeline View:***
    a. *Aggregated timeline of all major life events for a client across institutions.*

These future capabilities could inform current system architecture to ensure flexibility for expansion without rework.

Key Flows/Logic

The end-to-end experience for advisors will be designed collaboratively with engineering and design partners. At a high level, the flow is envisioned as follows:

1. *A confirmed life event is detected via third-party and first-party integrations.*
2. *The event is enriched with demographic and financial metadata.*
3. *The enriched event is pushed to subscribed advisor platforms through webhooks.*
4. *The advisor receives a prioritized notification with recommended actions.*
5. *All data interactions are monitored and logged for compliance.*

This section will evolve with annotated user stories, detailed flow diagrams, and acceptance criteria as the design process progresses. All updates will be captured in the Changelog and communicated to contributors.

REVIEWER	TEAM/ROLE	STATUS
Varun Nair	Senior Product Manager	Reviewed

Technical Details

This section will house implementation specifications and API documentation that underpin the ET-WAPI platform. As the project evolves, it will include:

- API endpoint definitions with request/response formats and authentication schemes
- Data schema details and enrichment logic
- Webhook delivery protocols and retry behavior
- Sample payloads for key events (e.g., job change, divorce)
- Versioning policy and deprecation strategy

We plan to structure ET-WAPI's documentation to meet the clarity and developer experience standards exemplified by leading APIs such as Stripe's API Reference. Although our documentation is still under development, this link serves as a model for the expected formatting and usability.

If maintained externally, technical documentation will be published here: Github

This section ensures future developers, partners, and stakeholders can independently understand, maintain, and extend the product.

Cost vs. Benefit Analysis

Cost Estimate:

- Engineering: 2 full-time developers over 10 weeks = ~20 dev weeks
- Product & Design: 0.5 FTE for 10 weeks = ~5 PM/design weeks
- QA, Legal, Data Integration: ~5 supporting weeks
- **Total Estimated Cost**: ~$150,000–$200,000 (based on blended rate of $8–10K per dev week)

Potential Benefits:

- Improved advisor responsiveness leading to increased AUM
- If each advisor captures $1M+ in new AUM through proactive outreach per year, even a 10% uptick across 100 advisors represents **$10M+ in additional AUM**
- Assuming a 0.5–1% revenue yield on AUM, this translates to **$50K–$100K in annual revenue uplift** per 100 advisors
- Strategic benefit: Differentiates product offering in the competitive WealthTech ecosystem and supports advisor retention

Simple ROI Estimate:

- Conservative Year 1 Revenue Uplift: $50K
- Project Cost: $150K–$200K
- **ROI Year 1 = 25–33%**, with compounding upside in Years 2–3 as adoption scales

This cost-benefit analysis supports the investment case for ET-WAPI and serves as a key input for decision-making during roadmap prioritization.

Scaling Plans

Scaling the Product

- Start with a focused rollout for U.S.-based advisors and job change/marriage events.
- Expand to support additional life events (e.g., inheritance, relocation) based on feedback and adoption.
- Extend coverage to international markets by integrating regional third-party data sources.

Scaling the Architecture

- Move from batch processing to a real-time, event-driven pipeline.
- Use horizontal scaling and distributed queues (e.g., Kafka) to manage spikes in event traffic.
- Implement caching, versioning, and rate limiting for stable long-term usage.

Scaling Across Teams

- Build internal dashboards and reporting tools for advisor operations.
- Add role-based access controls and audit logs to meet compliance needs.
- Enable self-service onboarding for CRM integration partners.

Anticipated Bottlenecks

- API rate limits under high-volume advisors → Use exponential backoff and circuit breaking.
- New regulatory requirements in cross-border data usage → Modularize compliance logic.

Metrics to Monitor During Scale

- API latency and uptime
- Advisor engagement per event type
- Number of life events processed per day
- Support tickets and bug reports by release cohort

Launch Plan

Key Milestones

TARGET DATE	MILESTONE	DESCRIPTION	EXIT CRITERIA
2025-06-01	✅ Pilot	Internal testing with employees only	No P0 or P1 bugs on a rolling 7-day basis
2025-07-15	🔵 Beta	Early cohort of 20 advisors	At least 10 advisors would be disappointed if we took it away
2025-08-15	🟡 Early Access	Invite-only advisors from sales	At least 1 win from every major competitor
2025-09-30	🟢 Launch	All advisors in the current markets	95%+ uptime and positive NPS on advisor usability

Operational Checklist

TEAM	PROMPT	Y/N	ACTION (if yes)
Analytics	Do you need additional tracking?		Work with [person] on logging
Sales	Do you need sales enablement materials?		Work with [person]
Marketing	Does this impact shared KPI?		Work with [person] on goal adjustment
Customer Success	Do you need to update support content or training?		Work with [person] on updates
Product Marketing	Do you need a GTM plan? (e.g. pricing, packaging, positioning,		Work with [person] with at least [x] weeks notice to kickoff workstreams
Partners	Will this impact any external partners?		Work with [person] on communication plan
Globalization	Are you launching in multiple countries?		Work with [person]

Risk	Does this expose a risk vector?		Work with [person]
Legal	Are there potential legal ramifications?		Work with [person]

Appendix

Changelog

TARGET DATE	AUTHOR	CHANGE SUMMARY
2025-04-25	Varun Nair	Initial PRD draft created, including goals, approach, features
2025-04-25	Varun Nair	Added Non-goals, Reviewer Table, and Tagline
2025-04-25	Varun Nair	Inserted Key Flows, Logic, and updated Launch Plan with dates
2025-04-25	Varun Nair	Incorporated Risk/Dependencies and Contingency Plans

Open Questions

Question	Owner	Status
What are the legal constraints on third-party data usage?	Legal	Unresolved
Do we need a user consent refresh at specific intervals?	Compliance	Pending
Will webhook scaling support 100+ advisors on day 1?	Engineering	In Progress
How will advisor feedback be collected post-launch?	Customer Success	Unresolved

FAQs

Q: Is ET-WAPI a full CRM solution?
A: No. ET-WAPI is designed to complement existing CRMs by providing real-time life-event triggers via API.

Q: How does the API protect client data?
A: All data is handled through consented sources, encrypted in transit, and follows strict audit and compliance logging.

Q: Who benefits from this product the most?
A: Wealth advisors and firms that manage HNW/UHNW clients who value proactive, personalized service.

Q: How will this be priced?
A: Pricing will follow a tiered usage-based model, with plans based on API volume and event enrichment level.

Impact Checklist

Category	Impact Consideration	Status
Permissions	Does the system need role-based access?	Yes
Reporting	Do we need dashboards or usage insights?	Yes
Pricing	Is a tiered or usage-based model appropriate?	Yes
API	Are endpoints documented and versioned?	In Progress
Global	Will localization or data residency apply?	Pending